



(BE) USED TO

WHEN, WHILE

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Quick Review

1. Used to (past habits that are now finished)

Form:

- **Affirmative:** Subject + **used to** + infinitive
- **Negative:** Subject + **didn't use to** + infinitive
- **Question:** **Did** + subject + **use to** + infinitive?

Examples:

- Affirmative: I **used to** live in a small village. (Now I live in a big city.)
- Negative: She **didn't use to** like vegetables. (Now she loves them.)
- Question: **Did** you **use to** play the piano when you were a child?

2. Be used to (be accustomed / familiar with something)

Form:

- **Affirmative:** Subject + **am / is / are used to** + noun / -ing form
- **Negative:** Subject + **am / is / are not used to** + noun / -ing form
- **Question:** **Am / Is / Are** + subject + **used to** + noun / -ing form?

Examples:

- Affirmative: He **is used to** driving on the left. (It is normal for him.)
- Negative: They **are not used to** the hot weather here.
- Question: **Are** you **used to** eating spicy food?

3. When + past simple and While + -ing (Past Continuous)

We use these to talk about time in the past:

- **When** + past simple = for shorter or interrupting actions.
- **While** + -ing = for longer / background actions happening at the same time.

Examples:

- **When** I arrived home, it **started** to rain. (short action)
- I **was cooking** **while** my wife **was watching** TV. (two longer actions at the same time)
- **While** I **was driving**, I **saw** an accident.

Exercises

Exercise 1: Choose the correct form

(Used to / Be used to)

Complete the sentences with the correct form.
Use **used to**, **didn't use to**, **is used to**, **isn't used to**, etc.

1. When I was young, I _____ (play) outside every day.
2. Maria _____ (live) alone, so she sometimes feels lonely now.
3. _____ you _____ (speak) English as a child?
4. They _____ (the cold winter) because they come from a warm country.
5. He _____ (smoke), but he stopped five years ago.

Exercise 2: Affirmative, Negative or Question

Rewrite the sentences in the form given in brackets.

1. I used to wake up at 6 a.m. (**Negative**)
→ _____
2. She is used to living in a noisy city. (**Question**)
→ _____
3. They didn't use to have a car. (**Affirmative**)
→ _____
4. Are you used to this new job? (**Negative**)
→ _____

Exercise 3: When or While?

Put the verbs in the correct form (**when** + past simple or **while** + -ing).

1. I _____ (meet) my best friend _____ I _____ (study) at university.
2. _____ she _____ (cook) dinner, the phone _____ (ring).
3. _____ I _____ (walk) in the park, it suddenly _____ (start) to rain.
4. He _____ (read) a book _____ the children _____ (play) outside.

Exercise 4: Mixed Practice – Write your own sentences

Write **one affirmative**, **one negative**, and **one question** for each point.

A. Used to

- Affirmative:

- Negative:

- Question:

B. Be used to

- Affirmative:

- Negative:

- Question:

C. When + past simple / While + -ing

- Sentence with **when**:

- Sentence with **while**:

Homework Tip:

Try to write a short paragraph (5-6 sentences) about your life before and now. Use **used to**, **be used to**, **when**, and **while**.
